

AETHER WIRELESS · KNOWLEDGE BASE

Payment Policy

Category B — Policy & Process Knowledge Base

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Overview

This policy establishes the accepted payment methods, autopay enrollment, payment windows, installment plan options, fee schedule, and deposit requirements for Aether Wireless customers. All payment transactions are processed in accordance with federal regulations and Aether Wireless standard operating procedures. Customers are responsible for ensuring timely payment to maintain service continuity and avoid disruption.

Payment Methods

Accepted Payment Methods

Aether Wireless accepts the following payment methods, each with associated processing times:

Payment Method	Processing Time	Availability
Credit/Debit Card (Visa, Mastercard, American Express, Discover)	Instant	Online, Mobile App, Customer Care, Retail
ACH Bank Transfer	3–5 Business Days	Online, Mobile App, Customer Care
Digital Wallet (Apple Pay, Google Pay, PayPal)	Instant	Online, Mobile App
In-Store Cash or Card	Instant	Retail Locations
Mailed Check	7–10 Business Days	Mail-in Payments

Processing times begin once the payment is successfully submitted and confirmed. ACH transfers initiated on weekends or holidays are processed on the next business day.

Prepaid Cards

Prepaid cards may be used for one-time payments only. Recurring payment setups (including autopay) do not support prepaid cards due to verification and authorization requirements.

Autopay

Enrollment and Discount

Autopay is enabled by default for all new customers upon account activation. Customers may opt out at any time through the online portal, mobile app, or by contacting customer care.

Customers enrolled in autopay on Premium, Unlimited, or Business plan tiers receive a **\$5 per month discount** on their service charges. The discount applies to the monthly recurring service fee and is reflected on the billing statement.

Retry Process

When an autopay transaction fails, Aether Wireless initiates an automatic retry process:

- **First Retry:** Automatically attempted 3 business days after the initial failure
- **Second Retry:** Automatically attempted 5 business days after the initial failure (within the same billing cycle)
- **Retry Fee:** A **\$5 fee** applies to each failed autopay attempt after the two automatic retries have been exhausted

Customers are notified via email and SMS after each failed attempt. It is the customer's responsibility to ensure sufficient funds or update payment information to avoid service suspension.

Payment Due Dates and Windows

All Aether Wireless accounts are assigned a monthly billing cycle with a payment due date. Customers receive a **15-day grace window** from the billing statement date to submit payment in full without incurring late fees.

Payments must be received and processed within this 15-day window. Payments submitted after the due date but within the 15-day window are considered timely. Accounts with outstanding balances remaining after the 15-day window are subject to late fees and potential service suspension.

Installment Payment Plans

Eligibility Requirements

Customers must meet all of the following criteria to qualify for an installment payment plan:

- Account status must be **Active** (not suspended or terminated)
- Account tenure of **12 months or longer** with Aether Wireless
- Outstanding balance of **at least \$100**
- No existing installment plan currently active
- No more than one plan completed within the past 6 months

Terms and Conditions

Installment payment plans operate under the following terms:

- **Maximum Duration:** 3 monthly installments
- **First Plan:** **0% interest** (interest-free)
- **Subsequent Plans:** **5% interest** applied to the remaining balance
- **Frequency Limit:** One installment plan per 6-month period
- **Approval Threshold:** Balances exceeding **\$500** require manager approval before activation

Once approved, the installment agreement is added to the customer's account. The total balance is divided into equal monthly payments due on the customer's standard billing dates. Failure to make installment payments may result in late fees and service suspension.

Late Fees and Returned Payments

Aether Wireless assesses the following fees for payment-related issues:

Fee Type	Amount	Triggering Event
Late Payment Fee	\$10	Payment received after the 15-day due window
Returned Payment Fee	\$25	Check, ACH, or card payment returned by bank
Chargeback Fee	\$35	Customer disputes a charge resulting in reversal

Returned payments may trigger additional retry attempts at the customer's expense. Repeated returned payments may result in account restrictions requiring alternative payment methods.

Security Deposits for New Customers

New customers establishing service with Aether Wireless may be required to pay a refundable security deposit based on credit evaluation:

- **Deposit Range:** \$100 to \$500
- **Refund Eligibility:** Deposits are refunded after **12 consecutive months** of on-time payments
- **Application:** The deposit is applied to the final bill upon account closure or retained as a credit toward future charges

Deposits do not accrue interest. Customers who demonstrate consistent payment history may request an early deposit review after 6 months of on-time payments, subject to management approval.

FAQs

Q: Can I change my payment method after autopay is enrolled?

A: Yes. You may update your payment method at any time through the online portal, mobile app, or by contacting customer care. Changes take effect for the next billing cycle.

Q: What happens if my check payment is lost in the mail?

A: Aether Wireless is not responsible for lost or delayed mail. If payment is not processed within the expected timeframe, late fees may apply. We recommend using electronic payment methods for faster processing and confirmation.

Q: Can I set up autopay if I use a prepaid card?

A: No. Prepaid cards cannot be used for recurring autopay payments. You must link a valid credit card, debit card, or bank account to enroll in autopay.

Q: How do I request a refund of my security deposit?

A: Deposits are automatically refunded after 12 months of on-time payments. If your account is closed before the 12-month period, the deposit is applied to your final bill, and any remaining balance is mailed as a check within 30 days.

Q: Is the \$5 autopay discount available on all plan tiers?

A: The \$5 monthly autopay discount applies only to Premium, Unlimited, and Business plan tiers. Standard and basic plans are not eligible for this discount.

Q: Can I get a second installment plan within the same year?

A: No. Customers are limited to one installment plan per 6-month period. You must fully pay off an existing plan before requesting a new one.

For questions about this policy, contact Aether Wireless Customer Care at 1-800-AETHER-1 or visit your nearest retail location.